



Figure 5: Firewall &gt; Firewall settings



Figure 6: Logs &gt; Log settings

non-transparent mode, coupled with blocking of direct HTTPS requests, ensures filtering of this and HTTP traffic via URLFilter. A proxy working in non-transparent mode terminates all connections to the Internet. Further, it initiates a separate connection to the Internet. Thus, there is no direct connection from the client system to the Internet, isolating the client system.

The default firewall settings (Figure 5) enable all traffic from Green to Red. This menu also embeds a popular add-on for the earlier version, Block Outgoing Traffic. The GUI has changed slightly for the embedded BOT.

**Caution:** Be careful while you configure this; you may inadvertently open the firewall completely for Red to Green traffic.

IPCop generates and displays various logs, on a last come-first-display basis, by default. Frequently, the most



Figure 7: Logs - System logs

recent logs are relevant and require to be seen. The *Logs > Logs Settings* page gives us a selection to reverse the chronological order of the log display. This menu also configures a time-frame to archive logs and summaries. The log information can also be passed on to a syslog server by specifying its IP address and protocol.

IPCop enables viewing of various logs, which are also valuable for troubleshooting. Important options include Proxy, OpenVPN, DNS, Red logs, etc. An interesting Red log for the PPPoE connection is 'Waiting for PADO Packets' followed by 'Red can not establish connection'. Most of the time, this spells an ISP-side error; just log a maintenance call.

Various other setting options include browsing time restrictions, download throttling to the specified download speed limit, enabling only specified browsers to access the Internet, integration with Windows AD to allow AD authenticated access, and so on. To sum up, IPCop 2.0 provides a robust firewall, which can be configured to browse the Internet securely. Being available under the GNU license, it is free for all, and is in use widely across the world. So, happy browsing! 

## References

- IPCop download: <http://www.ipcop.org/download.php>
- IPCop forum: [www.ipcops.com](http://www.ipcops.com)

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